Innovation Village Platform

Concept Note: a record that grows every year

Prepared by Future Studio

Purpose

The Innovation Village runs every year. This platform is built so that each edition adds to one growing record the village can use to decide what to do next.

It welcomes anyone with an innovation (startups, SMEs, students, inventors, community initiatives), lets the people who can help find them, and keeps track of every connection and result, year after year.

WHO CAN HELP

Investors, mentors, sponsors, partners and buyers

How it works

1 Register once

Everyone says what they do and what they look for, and gets a QR code that works as a badge.

2 The village reviews

Nothing goes live until the village team approves it.

3 Visitors browse

A searchable showcase by sector, stage, cohort and year.

4 Meetings are proposed

Declared interests and availability suggest meetings; the village team confirms.

5 Helpers express interest

An "I want to help" button sends a request to the village queue.

6 Everything is recorded

Against the person, the innovation and the edition, so years can be compared.

The introduction request queue

The village always assesses introductions itself. Off-site and post-event introductions never expose contact details directly; on site, people can also swap contacts by scanning badges. Each request is logged with:

- Who is asking: their organisation and role
- Which innovation they are interested in, and why
- The type of help offered
- The team member who handled it, and the outcome

STATUS FLOW

Received > Under review > Approved > Introduced > Closed

A record that grows every year

Every registration, meeting and outcome goes into one permanent record tagged by edition, so the village decides from evidence, not memory.

Record	What it holds	Question it answers over time
People and organisations	One lasting profile each: role, sector, interests, updated yearly	Who keeps coming back? Which helpers become repeat supporters?
Innovations	Listing, sector, stage, help needed, editions attended	Which sectors are growing? How far do innovations move between years?
Interactions	Meetings, pitches, introduction requests, who handled them	Which introductions actually lead somewhere?
Outcomes	Funding, pilots, partnerships, mentorship, followed up after the event	Did the village produce results, and for whom?
Event activity	Aggregated, anonymised counts of visitors and sessions	What drew people in, and what should change?

Four rules keep the record useful

- **Edition tags**
  Every record carries its edition (2026, 2027...), and a person or innovation keeps one identity across years.
- **Same questions each year**
  Data is collected at fixed moments (registration, on site, follow-up) so years can be compared.
- **Consent and a data charter**
  Consent is asked at registration; the charter says who sees what and how long data is kept.
- **Aggregated public views**
  Public figures are anonymised; personal detail is visible only to authorised village staff.

Core platform features

One registration and badge

QR code, no repeat registration, no app to install

Profiles with interests

Declared interests and availability propose meetings

Public showcase

Approved innovations by sector, stage and edition

Lounge tools

Meeting booking, recorded pitches, badge contact exchange, personal recap

Request queue

Introductions assessed by the village team

Admin dashboard

Approvals, queue, live counts and reports

Editions

Each year is a new edition in the same database

Dashboard and reporting

Three views on the same record: today's activity and the long-term trend in one place.

Live, during the event

Registrations, check-ins, meetings held and introductions requested, as aggregated counts that can feed the village's data wall.

After the event

Follow-up results such as funding, pilots, partnerships and mentorship.

Year over year

Innovations by sector and stage, visitor and helper mix, introductions and outcomes, with editions side by side.

One export gives the village its funder reports and published impact report.

How this fits the Village concept book

The book describes the 2026 event. It expects registration, matched meetings and live counts; the lasting multi-year record is Future Studio's addition.

Village space	What the book expects	Our part
Welcome Gate	One badge, one registration, conference accreditations recognised	Registration and QR badge
Investment and Networking Lounge	Meetings from declared interests, short pitches with follow-up, badge contact exchange	Profiles, meeting proposals, booking, follow-up
Data wall	Aggregated live counts of meetings and connections	Live feed from the dashboard
Impact report	Published after the event	Year-over-year reporting
Stretch items	AI briefs, secure data room, intentions board, founders' cafe, remote video	Later phases

Light AI, later

AI is not needed in the first edition. As the record grows each year, the village can add:

- **Auto-tagging**
  Sector and needs read from each innovation's description
- **Summaries and suggestions**
  Short listings and related innovations for helpers
- **Meeting briefs**
  A one-page brief on the other person for each meeting

The more editions of data the village has, the better these suggestions become.

Suggested phases

PHASE 1

First edition (2026)

Registration and badge, profiles, meeting proposals, request queue, live counts, and data tagged by edition so nothing is lost

PHASE 2

After the first edition

Follow up outcomes, first funder report, and review what data was captured and what is missing

PHASE 3

2027 onwards

Year-over-year dashboard, AI tagging, summaries and briefs, sponsor portal, secure data room, year-round community

Questions for the village

- Who funds the village, and what do those funders need to see in a report?
- Who owns the data across the years (the ministry, the village team, or both), and who can see personal details?
- How long is personal data kept, and what consent do people give at registration?
- Who on the village team will review innovations and handle introduction requests?
- Should some innovation details stay private until an introduction is approved?

Questions for the Future Studio team

A second product idea: an event contact and follow-up assistant. AI captures each contact you meet, summarises the conversation, and offers a next-morning follow-up email.

- Where does this product fit within Future Studio?
- Does it compete with anything we already do, or with other tools on the market?
- Does it belong to Future Studio, and how will it sit alongside the studio's other work?
- Can we use it to introduce what Future Studio does, by letting attendees use it and then meet the studio behind it?
- Should it later become the contact and follow-up layer in custom event projects like this one?